POSITION PAPER

Federal Republic of Germany

United Nations General Assembly (UNGA)

Agenda: Strengthening Global Actions and International Cooperation to Combat Climate Change

I. Background and international context

Climate change is a transboundary threat to human security, sustainable development, food and water systems, public health, and economic stability. Its impacts are not distributed equally: communities with limited infrastructure, financial resources, and adaptive capacity often face the greatest risks. The Federal Republic of Germany therefore considers climate action both an environmental necessity and a matter of international cooperation and fairness.

The international response is anchored in the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) and the Paris Agreement. The Paris Agreement seeks to hold the rise in global average temperature to well below 2°C above pre-industrial levels while pursuing efforts to limit it to 1.5°C. Its five-year cycle of progressively stronger Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), supported by transparency and the Global Stocktake, provides a framework for turning national plans into collective progress. Germany supports full implementation of this framework and recognises the principle of Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC): all states must contribute, while the scale and form of action should reflect historical contributions, capabilities, and national circumstances.

II. Germany’s national commitment and experience

Germany’s Federal Climate Action Act sets a reduction target of at least 65% in greenhouse-gas emissions by 2030 and at least 88% by 2040, compared with 1990 levels, and establishes greenhouse-gas neutrality by 2045. Germany’s energy transition also offers practical lessons: official German Environment Agency data reports that renewables supplied 55.1% of gross electricity consumption in 2025. This demonstrates that sustained policy, investment, and infrastructure expansion can increase clean electricity at scale, while also showing why grids, storage, heating, transport, and industry must progress alongside power generation.

Germany acknowledges that national targets require continuous implementation and scrutiny. It does not present its domestic transition as complete. Rather, Germany supports measurable national action combined with international partnerships that enable countries to pursue climate goals in ways suited to their circumstances.

III. Proposed strategies and practical solutions

Priority	Proposed action and implementation	How progress can be measured
1. Climate finance that reaches vulnerable communities	Strengthen access to grants and concessional finance for adaptation, especially for least developed countries and small island developing states. Use multilateral development banks, the Green Climate Fund, and national climate funds to combine public funding with carefully screened private investment. Prioritise flood protection, water security, heat-health plans, resilient schools and hospitals, and climate-smart agriculture. Publish project budgets, delivery milestones, and independent evaluations.	Funding approved and disbursed; time from application to approval; people and essential services protected; projects completed on schedule; resilience outcomes measured before and after investment.
2. Early-warning systems and risk-informed adaptation	Support national meteorological services, local hazard mapping, community alert systems, evacuation planning, and forecast-based early action. Connect satellite and weather data to local authorities, schools, health services, and farmers. Prioritise areas exposed to floods, heatwaves, drought, storms, and glacial hazards.	Population reached by reliable warnings; warning lead time; local response plans tested; coverage of high-risk districts; disaster losses and service disruption tracked over time.

Priority	Proposed action and implementation	How progress can be measured
3. Renewable energy with reliable infrastructure	Expand solar, wind, and other locally suitable renewables alongside grid upgrades, interconnectors, battery and other storage options, demand response, and transparent electricity planning. Pair new generation with training for grid operators and affordable access programmes so the transition is reliable and inclusive.	Renewable share of electricity; grid connection waiting times; transmission capacity added; outage frequency and duration; clean-energy access and affordability.
4. Technology transfer and capacity-building	Create voluntary regional partnerships among universities, technical institutes, governments, and industry. Support affordable licensing, joint research, local manufacturing where viable, maintenance training, and knowledge-sharing on clean power, efficient buildings, water systems, and climate-smart agriculture. Respect intellectual-property rules while improving practical access.	Number of training places completed; technologies installed and maintained locally; project costs and performance; local technicians and institutions supported.
5. Transparent NDC implementation and just transition	Encourage countries to translate NDCs into sector plans for electricity, transport, buildings, industry, land use, and agriculture. Use public progress dashboards and consistent greenhouse-gas inventories, with technical support for states that lack data systems. Pair transition policies with worker retraining, social protection, and consultation with affected communities.	NDC milestones achieved; emissions trends by sector; reporting completeness; workers retrained and placed; affordability and energy-access indicators.

IV. Climate finance and international responsibility

Germany welcomes the New Collective Quantified Goal on Climate Finance agreed at COP29: at least US$300 billion per year by 2035 for developing countries, with broader efforts by all actors to scale finance from public and private sources to at least US$1.3 trillion per year by 2035. These figures should not be conflated: the US$300 billion goal is the agreed core target, while US$1.3 trillion is the wider scaling ambition. Germany supports predictable contributions, accessible application processes, transparent accounting, and a stronger balance between mitigation and adaptation finance. Where projects protect lives and essential public services but cannot generate revenue, grant-based support should be prioritised over debt-creating finance.

V. Position and call for cooperation

The delegation of Germany urges Member States to move beyond broad declarations and adopt a practical programme of cooperation built on five pillars: accessible climate finance; early-warning and adaptation systems; renewable energy supported by reliable grids and storage; technology partnerships and training; and transparent implementation of NDCs. Such measures should be voluntary where appropriate, nationally led, measurable, and supported by the UNFCCC system and relevant international financial institutions. Germany calls for a fair transition in which developed countries provide leadership and support, developing countries are enabled to participate fully, and all countries contribute according to their capabilities.

Germany stands ready to work with all delegations on a balanced resolution that turns climate commitments into funded, measurable, and locally effective action.

SELECTED SOURCES AND DATA NOTES

The following primary and institutional sources support the factual claims and proposed policy framework in this paper. Figures are identified by year and should be quoted with their context during debate.

1. Federal Climate Action Act (Germany), Section 3. National targets: at least 65% reduction by 2030 and 88% by 2040 compared with 1990; greenhouse-gas neutrality by 2045. Official English text.

2. German Environment Agency (Umweltbundesamt), renewable electricity indicator. Reports a 55.1% share of renewables in gross electricity consumption in 2025 and the national objective of at least 80% by 2030. Official indicator.

3. United Nations – The Paris Agreement. Temperature goal, five-year cycle of NDCs, and key elements of the Agreement. UN overview.

4. UNFCCC – Nationally Determined Contributions. Parties' obligations to prepare, communicate, and maintain successive NDCs; progression and highest possible ambition. UNFCCC resource.

5. UNFCCC – COP29 climate-finance outcome, 24 November 2024. At least US$300 billion annually by 2035 and wider efforts to scale finance to US$1.3 trillion annually by 2035. UNFCCC announcement.

6. International Energy Agency – Germany 2025. Analysis of Germany's energy transition, including grids, heating, hydrogen, infrastructure, and policy implementation. IEA executive summary.

Delegate note: This paper is written as Germany's position for committee debate. The proposed mechanisms are recommendations for a UNGA resolution, not claims that these programmes have already been adopted by the United Nations.